PassFrame tuition

Writing Technique

Year 5 Accelerated — Mark Scheme — Lesson Worksheet & Homework (tutor copy)

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. C — personification (the house "sighed")

2. A simile compares two things using 'like' or 'as' (e.g. "brave as a lion"); a metaphor states directly that one thing IS another, without "like" or "as" (e.g. "he was a lion in battle")

3. alliteration (repeated 's' sound)

4. B — The fog lay like a thick grey blanket

5. Example: Simile: "The dog snarled like a wild wolf." Metaphor: "The dog was a wild wolf, teeth bared." (accept any valid pair)

6. onomatopoeia — the sequence of sounds (spluttered, clunked, roared) builds tension and makes the engine's struggle to start feel real and immediate to the reader

7. "snatched" — suggests speed and a slightly greedy, urgent action, making the moment feel more dramatic than a plain verb like "took" or "grabbed"

8. A — Brave Ben bravely battled the beast

9. A and C (the sea "devoured"; autumn "painted" — human actions/abilities given to non-human things)

10. B — uses a powerful verb ("hurling") and vivid, specific imagery to create a dramatic, sensory image rather than the plain, generic statement in A

11. onomatopoeia — "cracked" and "sizzled" imitate the real sounds of lightning, making the description feel electric and immediate

12. Example: "She was a machine, relentless and unstoppable." — this suggests she is mechanical in her focus and determination, never tiring or giving up (accept any valid metaphor + explanation)

13. A — After the storm passed, the village fell silent

14. Personification — despair is given the human action of "wrapping itself" around her heart, which makes an abstract emotion feel physical, suffocating and inescapable, more powerful than simply saying "she felt despair"

15. A and C ("trudged wearily" and "plummeted downwards" use precise, vivid verbs; "went slowly" and "fell down" use plain, generic verbs)

Standard

1. Personification is a single instance of giving human qualities to something non-human (e.g. "the wind sighed"); an extended metaphor develops one comparison across multiple sentences or a whole passage. Personification can be part of an extended metaphor, but they are not the same thing

2. B — The storm raged as her anger grew (the weather mirrors/reflects the character's emotional state — pathetic fallacy)

3. Personification/metaphor — curiosity is described as "nibbling", a small, persistent physical action,

6. A and C (A combines a simile with a powerful verb; C combines personification — "howled and clawed" — with vivid verbs; B and D are plain statements with no technique)

7. Example: "The clock's hands crept forward, stealing away her remaining minutes one by one."

8. B — repetition and alliteration (the word "can" and the repeated hard 'c' sound)

11. Onomatopoeia ("hammered and drummed") and a simile ("like a thousand tiny fists") — together they make the sound of the rain feel both realistic and relentlessly aggressive, emphasising the intensity of the storm

12. A — Without warning, the ground began to shake (a fronted adverbial phrase, not a single adverb like B)

13. A and C (both open with a fronted phrase rather than the subject; B and D start with the subject)

which makes the abstract feeling of curiosity feel active and hard to ignore

4. Example: "The man shuffled into the room and slumped into the worn armchair, exhaling deeply." (accept any valid rewrite with a powerful verb and sensory detail)

5. C — Priya's stomach churned like a washing machine as she twisted her hands together (combines a simile and a physical 'showing' detail, rather than simply stating the emotion)

9. A short, sharp sentence creates a sudden change of pace, mirroring a sudden action or shock, and gives the moment dramatic impact that a longer, flowing sentence would soften

10. B — uses personification ("hush blanketed"), a simile ("like grasping fingers") and precise vocabulary to build atmosphere, rather than the plain, generic adjectives in A

14. Example: "She thrust her fists into the air, punching a hole in the sky of her own doubt." (accept any valid response using a powerful verb + another technique)

15. Personification — the exam papers are given the human ability to "glare" and "dare", which makes an ordinary object feel threatening and intimidating, capturing the character's anxiety more vividly than a literal description

Standard / Hard

1. Pathetic fallacy is a specific type of personification where the weather or natural surroundings reflect a character's mood or the mood of a scene (e.g. "the sky wept" during a sad moment). Personification more broadly can give human qualities to any non-human thing, not just weather linked to emotion

2. B — uses an extended metaphor (warden's whistle, inmates, cells, confinement) to sustain the comparison between school and prison, rather than simply stating the comparison as in C

3. "Wrenched" suggests great effort and force, almost violence, against resistance (the howling wind) — far more dramatic and specific than a plain verb like "opened" or "pulled"

4. Example: "Darkness swallowed the crumbling house, and every creak of its bones seemed to whisper a warning." (accept any valid rewrite using at least two techniques, e.g. personification + metaphor)

5. B is more sophisticated — it uses personification ("city's pulse quickened", "night claimed its throne"), a powerful verb ("bled") and vivid imagery to create atmosphere

6. A, B and C (simile — "like a serpent"; personification — greed "coiled" and is "hissing"; metaphor — describing greed indirectly as a snake-like presence)

7. Metaphor — comparing silence to "a held breath" captures the tension and anticipation in the moment, because a held breath implies both stillness and the certainty that something must eventually happen

8. B — uses varied sentence length and structure, a fronted adjective ("Terrified"), and powerful sensory detail ("heart hammering"), rather than the short, repetitive, choppy sentences in A or the flatter cause-and-effect structures in C and D

9. A very short sentence creates a sudden, dramatic pause that mirrors shock, finality or a sudden emotional blow, giving the idea more weight and impact than it would have within a longer, flowing sentence

10. Example: "Grief was a storm that never truly passed. (extended metaphor) Some days it raged, thunder crashing through every thought. (personification/metaphor

11. A and C ("slammed" suggests anger or frustration; "whispered" suggests secrecy or fear — both imply emotion beyond the action itself; B and D are neutral, plain verbs)

12. Metaphor — regret is compared to a physical "stone" that "drags him down", layering two ideas: the weight/heaviness of guilt, and the way it slows and burdens him with every step he takes

13. A — The old pipes gurgled and groaned in protest (onomatopoeia — gurgled, groaned — combined with personification — "in protest" implies a human-like complaint)

14. The repeated 'm' sound (alliteration) creates a relentless, pounding rhythm; the powerful verb "mauled" and the personification of the monsoon as merciless and violent together build a sense of overwhelming, deliberate destruction that a plain description could not achieve

15. B is more skilfully written — it uses a simile ("like a thousand impatient fists"), personification ("the city held its breath") and a powerful verb ("hammered") to build

and suggest the city is almost alive, rather than simply listing facts as in A

continued) Other days it merely drizzled, a quiet ache beneath grey skies. (extended metaphor continued)"

atmosphere and tension, rather than the three short, disconnected, purely factual sentences in A

Homework — Answers

Easy / Standard

1. C — personification

2. A simile compares using 'like' or 'as' (e.g. "as dark as velvet"); a metaphor says one thing IS another (e.g. "the sky was black velvet")

3. alliteration (repeated 't' sound)

4. B — The night sky looked like black velvet

5. Example: Simile: "The river roared like a wild beast." Metaphor: "The river was a wild beast, thrashing against its banks."

6. onomatopoeia — the sequence of sounds builds a sense of spectacle and excitement, making the fireworks display feel vivid and immediate

7. "hurled" — suggests power and speed, more dramatic than a plain verb like "threw"

8. A — Dangerous dragons danced dramatically

9. A and C (mountains "stood guard"; winter "crept in with icy fingers" — human actions given to non-human things)

10. B — uses a powerful verb ("hurling") and vivid imagery to create a dramatic, sensory image rather than the plain statement in A

11. onomatopoeia — "rattled" and "clanked" imitate real sounds, building tension and atmosphere in the dark

12. Example: "He was a mule, refusing to budge no matter how hard they pushed." — this suggests he is extremely stubborn and immovable, like the animal (accept any valid response)

13. A — Within seconds, chaos erupted

14. Personification — jealousy is given the human/animal action of "clawing", making an abstract emotion feel physical and painfully persistent

15. A and C ("crept silently" and "hurtled forwards" use precise, vivid verbs; "went quietly" and "moved forwards" use plain, generic verbs)

Standard

1. Personification is a single instance of giving human qualities to something non-human; an extended metaphor develops one comparison across several sentences or a whole passage. Personification can appear within an extended metaphor, but the two are not identical

2. B — Dark clouds gathered as his mood darkened (the weather mirrors the character's emotional state)

3. Personification — doubt is described as "whispering", making an abstract feeling of uncertainty feel like a persistent, quiet, intrusive voice

4. Example: "The woman shuffled into the kitchen, the kettle's whistle filling the silence as she waited." (accept any valid rewrite)

6. A and C (A combines a simile with a powerful verb; C combines personification — "bit and nipped" implying biting actions — with vivid verbs; B and D are plain statements)

7. Example: "The deadline crept closer each day, tapping impatiently on her shoulder."

8. A — alliteration (repeated 's' sound) and repetition (of "sea")

9. A short, sharp sentence creates a sudden pause that mirrors shock or a dramatic moment, giving it more weight and impact than a longer

11. Simile ("like a wild animal") and personification/powerful verbs ("screamed and tore") — together they make the wind feel like a deliberate, violent force attacking the tent, intensifying the danger of the scene

12. A — In the blink of an eye, everything changed

13. A and C (both open with a fronted phrase rather than the subject; B and D start with the subject)

14. Example: "Her shoulders sagged as the final whistle blew, hope draining from her like water through cupped hands." (accept any valid

sentence would

response with a powerful verb + another technique)

5. C — Jack's fists clenched like coiled springs as his jaw tightened (combines a simile with a physical 'showing' detail)

10. B — uses personification ("stillness settled"), a comparative image ("heavier than any gunfire") and precise vocabulary to build atmosphere, rather than the plain adjectives in A

15. Personification/metaphor — the deadline is compared to a storm cloud "ready to burst", which captures the sense of mounting pressure and inevitable crisis far more vividly than simply saying she felt stressed

Standard / Advanced

1. Pathetic fallacy is a specific type of personification where weather or surroundings reflect a character's mood (e.g. "rain wept down the window" during a sad scene). Personification more broadly can apply human qualities to anything non-human, not only weather tied to emotion

6. A, B and C (simile — "like a furnace"; personification — "anger burned... his words came out scorched"; metaphor — describing his words as "scorched", extending the fire image)

11. A and C ("hurled" suggests anger or frustration; "murmured" suggests shyness or shame — both imply emotion beyond the action; B and D are neutral, plain verbs)

2. B — sustains the comparison with specific detail ("calm one moment and capsizing the next"), rather than the plain statement in D or the vague statements in A and C

7. Metaphor — comparing time to a "thief" who "steals" her childhood personifies an abstract concept and suggests loss is happening against her will, gradually and unstoppably

12. Simile — loneliness is compared to "an old, familiar coat", a layered image: it suggests loneliness is heavy and ever-present, but also strangely comfortable and worn, because he has felt it so often

3. "Wrestled" suggests a real struggle and effort against resistance — much more vivid and specific than a plain verb like "pulled" or "closed"

8. B — uses a fronted adjective ("Exhausted"), varied sentence structure and flowing detail, rather than the short, repetitive sentences in A or the flatter cause-and-effect structures in C and D

13. A — The shutters banged and rattled, protesting the wind (onomatopoeia combined with personification — "protesting" implies a human-like complaint)

4. Example: "The station roared with impatient footsteps, and the departure board flickered its warnings like a countdown to chaos." (accept any valid rewrite using at least two techniques)

9. A very short sentence creates a sudden, dramatic pause that mirrors shock, emptiness or finality, giving the idea more weight and impact than it would have within a longer sentence

14. The repeated 'b' sound (alliteration) creates a harsh, pounding rhythm that mirrors the blizzard's force; the powerful verb "battered" and the personification of the blizzard as merciless together build an overwhelming sense of violent, relentless danger

5. B is more sophisticated — it uses a simile ("like spilled ink"), personification ("the forest held its breath") and precise, sensory vocabulary to build atmosphere and tension, rather than the plain, generic statement in A

10. Example: "Hope was a single flame in the darkness. (metaphor) It flickered and swayed, threatening to die with every gust of doubt. (personification/extended metaphor) But somehow, it refused to go out. (extended metaphor continued)"

15. B is more skilfully written — it uses a simile ("like a toy"), personification ("waves rearing like wild horses", "groaning hull") and powerful verbs ("hurled") to build atmosphere and tension, rather than the three short, disconnected, purely factual sentences in A